

ISABELLA CARO MONTINI

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D. in Political Science — Fields: Comparative Politics and Political Methodology

- *M.A. in Political Science (with distinction), May 2024*

Berkeley, CA

Aug 2022 – present

Stanford University

M.A. in Latin American Studies (with distinction)

Stanford, CA

Sep 2021 – Jun 2022

Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

B.A. in Political Science and Sociology

Berlin, Germany

Oct 2018 – Sep 2021

DISSERTATION PROJECT

Contested Governance, Contested Claims: *The Politics of Claim-Making in Urban Peripheries*

Committee: Alison Post (co-chair), Scott Straus (co-chair), Thad Dunning and Hillel Soifer

PUBLICATIONS

1. Pantaleão, B., **Montini, I. C.** (2025). When Elections Empower Crime: Political Protection and Milícia Expansion in Rio de Janeiro. *Latin American Politics and Society*.
2. Farag, M., **Montini, I. C.**, Schemm, P. (2026). Overcoming Impeachment Hurdles: Elite Polarization, Mass Mobilization and Corruption Scandals. *Forthcoming at the European Political Science Review*.
3. Farag, M., **Montini, I. C.**, Fontenay, J., Jung, H. R., Ladhar, S. (2023). Modalities of Power Sharing: Consociationalism after 50 Years - A Scoping Review (1969-2018). *Government and Opposition*.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. **Size Matters: Pork Politics and State Presence in Brazilian Municipalities** [[Working Paper](#)] (with Alison E. Post)
 - *In the News*: **O Estado de S. Paulo** (August 2025) and **Folha de S. Paulo** (June 2025)
2. **Under the Radar: Estimating Underreporting of Gender-Based Violence to the Police** [[Working Paper](#)] (with Jessie Trudeau)
3. **Gender-based Violence and Organized Crime: Evidence and Policy Recommendations for Latin America**. Policy document commissioned by the World Bank and the Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean [[Working Paper](#)] (with Jessie Trudeau)
4. **Electoral Rules and the Provision of Public versus Targeted Goods: Evidence from Mayoral Elections in Brazil** [[Working Paper](#) available upon request]
5. **Bringing the State Back In? The Decline of Criminal Service Provision in Rio de Janeiro** [[Working Paper](#) available upon request] (with Jessie Trudeau and David Becerra Medina)
6. **Criminalized Public Goods Provision** [Manuscript in preparation] (with Eduardo Moncada)
7. **Claim-Making and Public Goods Provision in Emerging Cities of the Global South** [Manuscript in preparation] (with Intissar Kherigi, Ellen Lust, Lucas Novaes, Jeffrey Paller, and Alison E. Post)
8. **The Paradox of Protection: Patterns of Gender-Based Violence Under Criminal Rule** [Data collection started] (with Johanna Reyes Ortega)

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

BeSample Dissertation Grant Award <i>BeSample ~ funds data collection for $N = 3,000$</i>	2026
IPA's Peace and Recovery Initiative Exploratory Grant (with Jessie Trudeau) <i>Innovations for Poverty Action ~ \$10,000</i>	2025
APSA/NSF Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant <i>American Political Science Association and National Science Foundation ~ \$15,000</i>	2025
APSA Centennial Center Research Grant <i>American Political Science Association ~ \$2,000</i>	2025
Peter H. Odegard Award for Outstanding Performance in Political Science <i>Department of Political Science, UC Berkeley</i>	2025
Simpson Research Grant in International Studies for ABDs <i>Institute for International Studies at UC Berkeley ~ \$15,000</i>	2025
Global Metropolitan Studies Summer Funding Competition <i>Center for Global Metropolitan Studies at UC Berkeley ~ \$5,000</i>	2025
CAF Policy Grant (with Jessie Trudeau) <i>Banco de Desarrollo de América Latina Y El Caribe ~ \$12,000</i>	2025
CEGA Development Economics Challenge (with Johanna Reyes Ortega) <i>Center for Effective Global Action ~ \$5000</i>	2025
John L. Simpson Pre-Dissertation Fellowship <i>Graduate Institute for Area Studies at UC Berkeley ~ \$5000</i>	2024
Political Economy Research Grant <i>BESI Network UC Berkeley ~ \$5000</i>	2024
Jim Fahey Safe Homes for Women Fellowship <i>Graduate Division at UC Berkeley ~ \$1000</i>	2024
Outstanding Teaching Award <i>UC Berkeley</i>	2024
UC Berkeley Diversity and Community Fellowship <i>Graduate Diversity (UC Berkeley ~ \$7500)</i>	2023
Path To Professoriate Fellow <i>Graduate Diversity (UC Berkeley)</i>	2022
Excellence Award for Academic Performance <i>Center for Latin American Studies (Stanford University)</i>	2022
Ayacucho Fellowship <i>Center for Latin American Studies (Stanford University ~ \$80,000)</i>	2021-22
DAAD scholarship for Outstanding International Students <i>Deutscher Akademischer Austauschdienst (German Academic Exchange Service ~ \$42,000)</i>	2018-21

TEACHING

Statistical Consultant for Honors Thesis Students <i>Statistical Consultant (Classes of 2026 and 2027)</i>	2025 – 2027 UC Berkeley
Math Camp for incoming Political Science Graduate Students <i>Instructor</i>	2025, 2026 UC Berkeley
PS 231B: Causal Inference <i>Graduate Student Instructor</i>	2025 UC Berkeley
PS 148A: Latin American Politics <i>Graduate Student Instructor</i>	2024 UC Berkeley
PS 147G: The Welfare State in Comparative Perspective <i>Graduate Student Instructor</i>	2023 UC Berkeley
Gender & the Politics of Intersectionality in Latin America <i>Instructor</i>	2021 HU Berlin
Gender & the Politics of Intersectionality <i>Instructor</i>	2020 HU Berlin

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Policy Consultant for the Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean (CAF)	2025
Researcher <i>FGVcidades</i>	2025 - present São Paulo, Brazil
Visiting Scholar <i>FGV - CEPESP</i>	May - July 2025 São Paulo, Brazil
Research Associate at the Center on the Politics of Development <i>UC Berkeley</i>	June 2022 - present Berkeley, CA
Research Fellow PovGov Lab <i>Stanford University, Department of Political Science</i>	Oct 2021 - present Stanford, CA
Getting into Grad School (GiGS) Mentor <i>UC Berkeley</i>	June 2022 - June 2023 Berkeley, CA
Research Assistant <i>Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Department of Social Sciences</i>	Sep 2019 - July 2021 Berlin, Germany

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Women in Political Science Representative <i>UC Berkeley</i>	May 2024 - August 2025
President of the Political Science Graduate Students' Association <i>UC Berkeley</i>	Jan 2024 - Jan 2025
Center on the Politics of Development Workshop Coordinator <i>UC Berkeley</i>	August 2023 - May 2024

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

Empirical Studies of Gender Research Network (EGEN) Annual Meeting (2026)
Guest Lecturer at the Department of Political Science and Metropolitan Studies at the University of São Paulo (2025)
Authors' Seminar for Policy Documents: Development Bank of Latin America (CAF) and the World Bank (2025)
REPAL (2025, 2026)
Center for the Politics and Economics of the Public Sector, *CEPESP - FGV* (2025)
Midwestern Political Science Association (2025, 2026)
Guest Lecturer, *Latin American Politics: Understanding Criminal Governance*, UC Berkeley (2024)
Urban Politics in the Global South (2024, 2025)
American Political Science Association (2024, 2025)
Latin American Studies Association Conference (2022, 2025)
European Consortium for Political Research (2021)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent), German (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent), Italian (Beginner)
Programming: R, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Markdown, QGIS, Git

FACULTY REFERENCES

Alison E. Post, Associate Professor of Political Science and Global Metropolitan Studies, UC Berkeley
Scott Straus, Professor of Political Science and Department Chair, UC Berkeley
Thad Dunning, Robson Professor of Political Science and Director of the Center on the Politics of Development, UC Berkeley
Beatriz Magaloni, Graham Stuart Professor of International Relations at the Department of Political Science, Stanford University